The House, Room by Room

Every job filed under the room where it happens — that is where you look, and how you see it undone. **Five colours: Ricardo, Julie, Lily, the domestic, the gardener.** No switches, no dates. Domestic Mon, Tue, Thu, Sat; gardener Tuesday and Friday — **Lily runs both**. **Ricardo pays for everything.**

THE WEEK
Standing week
No dates, no switches — domestic Mon · Tue · Thu · Sat, gardener twice

CHORES
60.2 h
Across the whole house — Julie carries the most

CARE
28.2 h
Sofia's feeds, baths and nights — not transferable

STILL OPEN
199 of 199
Tick the day it was done

The house

Front door
9.8 h
Ricardo carries most

Kitchen
16.3 h
Lily carries most

Kitchen table
4.2 h
Ricardo carries most

Living
1.2 h
shared by everyone

Bedrooms
10.6 h
Ricardo carries most

Laundry
8.1 h
Domestic carries most

Nursery
27.1 h
Julie carries most

Garden & pool
7.5 h
Gardener carries most

Study
3.1 h
Ricardo carries most

Garage
0.6 h
Ricardo carries most

Who in which room

ROOM	RICARDO	JULIE	LILY	DOMESTIC	GARDENER	ROOM TOTAL
Front door & the school run	9.4 h	—	0.4 h	—	—	9.8 h
Kitchen & scullery	2.4 h	5.1 h	8.8 h	—	—	16.3 h
The kitchen table	1.8 h	1.8 h	0.5 h	—	—	4.2 h
Living & dining	—	—	—	—	—	1.2 h
Bedrooms & bathrooms	5 h	2.3 h	—	3 h	—	10.6 h
Laundry & linen	—	—	4 h	4.1 h	—	8.1 h
The nursery	0.5 h	26.6 h	—	—	—	27.1 h
Garden, pool & bins	2.3 h	—	—	0.3 h	4.7 h	7.5 h
The study & paperwork	1.8 h	0.5 h	0.8 h	—	—	3.1 h
Garage & cars	0.6 h	—	—	—	—	0.6 h
Whole house	**23.9 h**	**36.3 h**	**14.4 h**	**7.4 h**	**4.7 h**	**86.7 h**

Room by room

Front door & the school run

9.4h Ricardo · 0.4h Lily

Bags by the door at 07:25, both girls delivered on time, nothing forgotten twice.

School drop-off — Donatella & Gianna, doors close 08:00

Ricardo · M T W T F · 30 MIN

Mon · Tue · Wed · Thu · Fri · Weekdays

Leave 07:30, one driver, both girls.

Pick-up — Gianna, Grade 1 ends 13:30

Ricardo · M T W T · 20 MIN

Mon · Tue · Wed · Thu · Mon–Thu

Pick-up — Donatella 14:00, or aftercare / field at 15:00

Ricardo · M T W T · 25 MIN

Mon · Tue · Wed · Thu · Mon–Thu

Friday early pick-up — Gianna 12:45, Donatella 13:15

Ricardo · F · 40 MIN

Friday

Extra-mural run — hockey, kit and water

Ricardo · M T · 50 MIN

Mon · Thu

Extra-mural run — tennis

Ricardo · T · 45 MIN

Tuesday

Extra-mural run — swimming squad

Ricardo · W · 50 MIN

Wednesday

Lunch boxes and water bottles into bags

Lily · M T W T F · 5 MIN

Mon · Tue · Wed · Thu · Fri · Weekdays

Packed the night before — Sunday night for Monday.

Kitchen & scullery

2.4h Ricardo · 5.1h Julie · 8.8h Lily

Counters clear, dishwasher on, tomorrow's food already decided.

Wake the girls, breakfast on the table

Mon · Tue · Wed · Thu · Fri · Weekdays

Ricardo — M T W T F — 20 MIN

Breakfast reset — dishes, counters, table

Mon · Tue · Wed · Thu · Fri · Weekdays

Lily — M T W T F — 10 MIN

Meal plan — seven dinners, written down

Sunday

Julie — S — 25 MIN

Food check — the list against the fridge and the pantry

Wednesday

Wednesday checks, Thursday buys.

Julie — W — 20 MIN

Food shop — against the Wednesday list

Thursday

Lily — T — 60 MIN

Top-up — milk, bread, fruit

Monday

Tuesday works just as well.

Lily — M — 25 MIN

Lunch boxes packed — for the next day

Mon · Tue · Wed · Thu · Sun · School nights

Sunday packs Monday; Thursday packs Friday, so Friday carries no box.
Separate job from the meal at the table.

Lily — M T W T S — 15 MIN

Lunch — the midday meal at the table

Mon · Tue · Wed · Thu · Fri · Sat · Weekdays and Saturday

The meal at home, not the boxes. Sunday lunch is out.

Julie, Lily — M T W T F S — 25 MIN

Sunday lunch — out

Sunday

Julie — S — 10 MIN

Dinner cooked

Every day

Friday take-out is Ricardo's; Sunday is light.

Julie, Lily, Ricardo — M T W T F S S — 45 MIN

Dishes and the kitchen closed

Every day

Lily — M T W T F S S — 15 MIN

Batch cook — one dinner ahead for the week

Sunday

Julie — S — 40 MIN

5

The kitchen table

1.8h Ricardo · 1.8h Julie · 0.5h Lily

Homework done before screens, reading heard, uniform out and checked for tomorrow.

Homework — both girls, one sitting

Mon · Tue · Wed · Thu · Fri · School days

Rotates Ricardo → Julie → Lily and carries into next week.

R Ricardo · J Julie · L Lily — M T W T F — 30 MIN

Reading practice — 15 minutes each

Mon · Tue · Wed · Thu · Fri · School days

R Ricardo · J Julie — M T W T F — 15 MIN

Packed bags and signed diary at the door

Mon · Tue · Wed · Thu · Sun · School nights

Sunday night is Ricardo's bag pack.

J Julie · R Ricardo — M T W T S — 5 MIN

Living & dining

Table cleared, floor clear, everyone at dinner for twenty minutes without a phone.

Family dinner at the table — no phones, everyone present

Every day

· Everyone — M T W T F S S — 30 MIN

Table set and cleared

Every day

K Kids — M T W T F S S — 10 MIN

Ten-minute reset — every room back to zero

Every day

· Everyone — M T W T F S S — 10 MIN

Bedrooms & bathrooms

5h Ricardo · 2.3h Julie · 3h Domestic

Girls in bed by 19:45, bathrooms dry, beds made, their rooms walkable.

Dressed, teeth, shoes, bags by the door

Mon · Tue · Wed · Thu · Fri · Weekdays

J Julie — M T W T F — 15 MIN

Bath and bed — the girls, 18:30 and 19:15

Every day

R Ricardo — M T W T F S S — 40 MIN

Bathrooms and floors — deep clean

Mon · Tue · Thu · Sat · Domestic days

D Domestic — M T T S — 45 MIN

Their rooms reset and declutter

Saturday

K Kids — S — 20 MIN

Sofia — bath, every second day

Mon · Wed · Fri · Sun · Every 2nd day · care

Sunday is Ricardo's bath with her.

J Julie · R Ricardo — M W F S — 20 MIN

Laundry & linen

4h Lily · 4.1h Domestic

Basket empty, one load in the machine, school kit dry by Sunday night.

Laundry — loads in, hung, folded

Mon · Tue · Thu · Sat · Domestic days

D Domestic — M T T S — 45 MIN

Laundry — Lily's days

Wed · Fri · Sun · 3×/week

L Lily — W F S — 45 MIN

Bed linen changed

Monday

Monday, every week — the beds are stripped in the first block of her day.

D Domestic — M — 20 MIN

Ironing — the week's shirts and uniforms

Tuesday

D Domestic — T — 45 MIN

Baby clothing — every second day

Tue · Thu · Sat · Every 2nd day

L Lily — T T S — 15 MIN

Uniforms — checked and back in the bags

Wed · Fri · Sun · 3×/week

Lily checks; the domestic washes. The domestic takes the other four days.

L Lily — W F S — 20 MIN

The nursery

0.5h Ricardo · 26.6h Julie

Nappies, wipes and a change of clothes stocked; bath every second day; the nights are Julie's.

Sofia — feeds through the day

Every day · care

J Julie — M T W T F S S — 45 MIN

Sofia — naps and settling

Every day · care

J Julie — M T W T F S S — 40 MIN

Sofia — nappies and changes

Every day · care

J Julie R Ricardo — M T W T F S S — 15 MIN

Sofia — nights, 22:00–06:00

Every day · care

One line, and it is Julie's — counted at two hours a night.

J Julie — M T W T F S S — 120 MIN

Bottles and sterilising

Every day · care

J Julie — M T W T F S S — 10 MIN

Nappies and wipes stocked

Sunday

J Julie — S — 15 MIN

Garden, pool & bins

2.3h Ricardo · 0.3h Domestic · 4.7h Gardener

Pool clear and tested, bins out Sunday night, lawn under control, nothing loose in the wind.

Pool — skim, chlorine and pH test

Mon · Thu

R Ricardo | M | T | 20 MIN

Pool — full clean, brush, backwash

Saturday

R Ricardo | S | 60 MIN

Front and back garden — beds, edges, weeds

Tue · Fri

Front in the morning, back after lunch. Garden only — the pool stays with Ricardo.

G Gardener | T | F | 90 MIN

Lawn — mown, edges cut, clippings out

Tuesday

Once a week, on the Tuesday.

G Gardener | T | 60 MIN

Braai area — swept and washed

Friday

G Gardener | F | 20 MIN

Solar panel on the geyser — washed

Friday

First Friday of the month, cold morning, nothing abrasive.

G Gardener | F | 20 MIN

Braai — washed and covered

Monday

Ricardo lights it; the domestic washes it on the Monday.

D Domestic | M | 20 MIN

Bins out, then back in

Sunday

Refuse and recycling share one collection day.

R Ricardo | S | 10 MIN

House walk-round — gutters, geyser, alarms, bulbs

Sunday

R Ricardo | S | 30 MIN

Recycling sorted and flattened

Monday

K Kids | M | 10 MIN

The study & paperwork

1.8h Ricardo · 0.5h Julie · 0.8h Lily

Bills scheduled by the 25th, school emails answered inside 48 hours, nothing unopened.

Household consumables — detergent, paper, bulbs
Wednesday
Checked Wednesday, bought Thursday.
Julie · W · 15 MIN

Household consumables — the buy
Thursday
Lily · T · 25 MIN

Bills — statements checked, payments scheduled, receipts filed
Sunday
Ricardo pays for everything in this house. Nothing goes out on this board's authority.
Ricardo · S · 30 MIN

Bank and card reconciliation
Sunday
Ricardo · S · 15 MIN

School admin — forms, payments, calendar, trip letters
Wednesday
Ricardo · W · 20 MIN

Diary signing and school emails
Mon · Tue · Wed · Thu · Fri · Weekdays
Ricardo · M T W T F · 5 MIN

Week ahead — calendar sweep, clashes, lifts
Sunday
Julie · S · 15 MIN

Family meeting — the week, the roster, who is short
Sunday
Ricardo · S · 20 MIN

Domestic and gardener — days, standards and the list
Friday
Lily runs both: what the domestic covers on her four days, what the gardener leaves for next week.
Lily · F · 20 MIN

Medical aid, pharmacy repeats, appointments
Monthly
Julie

Birthdays, parties, RSVPs, gifts
Monthly
Julie

Policies, vehicle licences, insurance renewals
Monthly
Ricardo

School fees, aftercare, activity payments
Monthly
Ricardo

Garage & cars

0.6h Ricardo

Tank above a quarter, tyres checked monthly, car clean enough for the school gate.

Car — fuel, tyres, wash, service diary
Saturday
Ricardo · S · 15 MIN

Repairs and maintenance list
Saturday
Ricardo · S · 20 MIN

How this is built

The rules behind the rooms

1. **One owner per job per day.** The backup only steps in when the owner says so.
2. **Rooms, not categories.** A job lives where it happens — the pool test is outside, the bills are in the study, homework is at the kitchen table. If a job does not belong to a room, it does not belong on the list.
3. **The split follows the days people are in.** Domestic Monday, Tuesday, Thursday and Saturday for cleaning, laundry and the deep clean; Lily covers Wednesday, Friday and Sunday. The gardener takes the front then back, the lawn once a week, and nothing else — the pool stays with Ricardo. **Lily runs both**: their days, their standard and the list of what is still outstanding.
4. **The kitchen belongs to Julie and Lily** — with one exception: the braai is Ricardo's when he lights it. He pays for all of it, drives the road, runs bath and bed, and keeps the school admin.
5. **Feeding is not a chore.** The nursery sits outside the fairness maths — the 17:00–20:00 window and the nights are why the rest is distributed the way it is. Nights are Julie's, one line, 22:00–06:00.
6. **No configurations.** No "Ricardo away", no custody switch, no helper toggle. Everyone is home, the children are always here, and the board runs until a cell changes.

Fixed points

- **DOMESTIC** Mon, Tue, Thu, Sat — cleaning, laundry, uniforms.
- **GARDENER** Tuesday and Friday, front then back. The lawn once a week, the solar panel monthly.
- **STAFF** Lily runs both — days, standards, the list. Managed, not counted.
- **NIGHTS** Julie takes every night, 22:00–06:00, one line. Bath and the baby's washing every second day.
- **HOMEWORK** Every school day, both girls, rotating Ricardo → Julie → Lily.
- **BOXES** Packed the night before — Friday has no cell. Lunch is the meal at home; the boxes are a separate job.
- **MONEY** Ricardo pays. The board schedules and reminds; it never approves or sends.
- **BINS** Sunday night, with the house walk-round.

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Room standards are the household's own. Timings from the Reddam House Durbanville calendar; refuse and recycling per the City of Cape Town schedule; the pool on a standard skim / test / backwash cycle. Hours are computed from the minutes here. The domestic's week, the gardener's week and the check-and-plan list (Julie Wednesday, Lily Thursday) are drawn as week grids on The Maio Household Week, sheets 1.2, 1.3 and 2.2. Standing week, no dates. Nothing here is medical instruction — the midwife's word beats this board.